Camille Parmesan



Born in 1961, Professor Camille Parmesan is an American academic who has established a reputation as one of the leading climate change scientists. She received her Ph.D. in biological sciences from the University of Texas at Austin in 1995 and her early research concerned the evolution of insect–plant interactions. For the best part of 20 years, she has focused on documenting the shifting geographical ranges of butterflies across North America and Europe, linking these to climate change. Parmesan has been a leading figure in the IPCC and her work has won her many accolades and has been cited in hundreds of academic papers. She was elected a Fellow of the European Science Academy in 2018, and continues to write papers and advise international conservation bodies.

Key works

2003 "A globally coherent fingerprint of climate change impacts," *Nature*

2015 "Plants and climate change: complexities and surprises," *Annals of Botany*

Migration and hibernation

Birds that migrate in spring to reach rich food sources also face problems. Some have adjusted their flight schedules to benefit from the earlier abundance of insects. After making the long journey from sub-Saharan Africa, the first swallows arrive in the UK about 20 days earlier than they